Question ID 190be2fc

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	One-variable data: Distributions and measures of center and spread	

ID: 190be2fc

Data set A consists of 10 positive integers less than 60. The list shown gives 9 of the integers from data set A.

$$43, 45, 44, 43, 38, 39, 40, 46, 40$$

The mean of these 9 integers is 42. If the mean of data set A is an integer that is greater than 42, what is the value of the largest integer from data set A?

ID: 190be2fc Answer

Correct Answer:
52

Rationale

The correct answer is 52. The mean of a data set is calculated by dividing the sum of the data values by the number of values. It's given that data set A consists of 10 values, 9 of which are shown. Let x represent the 10th data value in data set A, which isn't shown. The mean of data set A can be found using the expression $\frac{43+45+44+43+38+39+40+46+40+x}{10}$, or $\frac{378+x}{10}$. It's given that the mean of the 9 values shown is 42 and that the mean of all 10 numbers is greater than 42. Consequently, the 10th data value, x, is larger than 42. It's also given that the data values in data set A are positive integers less than 60. Thus, $42 < x < 60$. Finally, it's given that the mean of data set A is an integer. This means that the sum of the 10 data values, $378 + x$, is divisible by 10. Thus, $378 + x$ must have a ones digit of 0. It follows that x must have a ones digit of 2. Since $42 < x < 60$ and x has a ones digit of 2, the only possible value of x is 52. Since 52 is larger than any of the integers shown, the largest integer from data set A is 52.

Question Difficulty:
Hard